

The Steam and Cogwheel Dragon Academy

A Free GURPS supplement

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1 GURPS Campaign Idea – The Steam and Cogwheel Dragon Academy

Dear Readers.

Below is my little idea for a campaign setting/story. It's mostly inspired by The Steam Dragon Express, a webcomic by Merryweather (it's available on Webtoon) and, of course, the Harry Potter series.

2 The Academy

The main setting would be **The Steam and Cogwheel Dragon Academy** – a school of magic set inside a big construct of a dragon. The dragon is magical and besides the ability to fly and spew fire, it also can host inside of itself a whole magical school (the space is twisted and enlarged).

The Steam and Cogwheel Dragon Academy prides itself on schools of magic that enable it's creation in the first place – the technomagic and magic of 4 elements, just like the Steam and Cogwheel Dragon is a magical construct, and dragons generally symbolize the magical harmony of the 4 basic elements (they got fish's scales, have wings and spew fire, plus they also got 4 powerful legs).

The Academy got created as a protective measure against the Empire of Dragon Blood (look below). The only thing that can oppose its dragons is magic, which the Academy teaches freely, at no cost (it also covers living expenses when studying). if the Empire would attack, then the Coalition would use the mages it taught directly in the war. also, the mechanical dragon was created as both the place of study and a weapon with power comparable to the greatest of imperial dragons.

2.1 Houses of the Academy

The houses of the Steam and Cogwheel Dragon Academy are this:

The House of Gravestone, which specializes in magic of earth and necromancy (since human remains are put into the soil after the death). They are the most dark and headstrong of all the houses – a trait that is pretty okay during the fights with the Empire of Dragon Blood, which is the only reason why they are possibly allowed to be taught at all. Yes, many dark mages come from this House, but far much more were used as a successful warriors in the fights across centuries.

The House of Holy Water, which specializes in magic of water and healing – since water is the basic for all living beings health. The house has an allyship with the House of Knowledge Saved in Cogs, as both of them consist of a type of scientists (doctors and engineers), just of various specialties. This House produced many holy people and great healers, but has somehow a reputation of being lame.

The House of Wind Rose teaches the magic of wind and movement. Of all the Houses, this one produces the most wizards with good-for-nothing aptitude. The magic they are learning has a reputation of being comparatively easy to learn, plus there are metaphorical wild winds blowing in the heads of many students. They do not take things seriously and wanna achieve the biggest deeds with the least amount of effort.

The House of Enchanted Blaze, which teaches the magic of fire and enchantment. Many noble wizards came from this House, but also it has a reputation of creating overly zealous fanatics who cannot maintain good balance between what needs to be done and what should. They are the fiery enemies of the house Gravestone.

The House of Knowledge Saved in Cogs, which specializes in magic of technology and knowledge (which enabled the technology to exist in the first place). They

aren't powerful warriors, but they help maintain the techno-miracles of the world, which are quite important for various reasons, from military to economical.

2.2 Notable Teachers

The Mournful Lady - an old crone who in her youthful days had a brief on romance with Mr. Lionheart only in order to turn him down, and who was a healer of the Holy Water House. When the new disease by the Necro King got dispersed among the people, her lover was one of the victims. Even though she put her best efforts, she was not able to save him. Then she turned away from healing magic and got interested in necromancy. She was able to keep her lover as a ghost, always by herself, but never being able to touch him ever again. As such, she is in perpetual grief.

The Mournful Lady wears dark dresses and tries to combine the magic of Houses of Holy Water and Gravestone in order to bring her love back to life. So far things aren't working to her advantage.

The Mournful Lady is the caretaker of Gravestone House, but is too busy with her own pain and magical resurrection projects in order to take proper care of her students. Which is why the cults of Necro King could happen below her very nose and she would be none the wiser.

Mx. Two Faces - an ghost condemned with the curse of duality. During day, Mx. Two Faces is a ghost of a serious, sad lady who goes by Eliza, who teaches the magic of illusions and light/darkness. She is a competent teacher, even if somehow distant due to being a ghost and her demeanor. During night, however, Mx. Two Faces turns into a mischievous poltergeist of masculine gender called Tom, who uses his knowledge of magic to cause chaos and play jokes - sometimes funny, sometimes nasty, it matters for him not - on students and other teachers. Mx. Two Faces, when is a lady, tries to find a magical cure to her condition, but after over 100 years of trying to work the solution, she starts to think that no cure exists at all.

Florian de Visse also known as **the Laid-back Satyr** - a handsome satyr that's a noble from the country of Belpaese. His specialty is the magic of wind and movement, but in truth, he's not too serious about his duties as caretaker of the House of Wind Rose. He's way more interested in tasting the joys and luxuries this world has to offer - the best wine, the most tasty food, the most beautiful people (Florian is openly bisexual). He also likes to relax with his choice of soft drugs and even provides them to his students - for a price, of course. There are rumors that he has an illegal plantation of Blue Roses for his personal use from the Rose Empire, but such things have never been proven.

Elenarila Thaciona Yllasatra - an elven teacher of magic of animals and plants, follower of old druidic tradition of her people. Nobody is quite sure how old she is and how long she teaches at the Academy, but the fact that she is a forest elf, and not sea elf, as her modern-day brethren, is telling much. Elenarila is well-liked by both students and other teachers, but can also be reclusive with time she spends in her grove inside the Steam and Cogwheel Dragon. She isn't really with touch with current events and politics, and seem to only realize way too late that years are passing her

by. She has a habit of mixing the names of her current students with those she taught hundreds of years previously.

Orwin Puddlestone - gnome which teaches the magic of Knowledge Saved in Cogs. He is the caretaker of the House too. He takes his teaching position very seriously and tried his best to foster in his students love of learning, knowledge and curiosity about the world and its magical laws. He also teaches Alchemy as an additional course for those who are interested in taking it. he seems to be much more focused to teach his students the way of thinking of truly scientific magic than deal with the mere encyclopedic facts themselves. Is someone is able to think critically and analyze the data, that someone will likely get a better grade during his exams than a rote-learning student.

Mr. Lionheart - greying knight who mastered the magic of flame and enchantment, caretaker of House of Enchanted Blaze. He is a fervent follower of the Fiery Swordman teaching, believing it's better to just stop existing at all, than becoming possibly a tool in a necromancer's hands. Besides magic of fire and enchantment, he also teaches swordplay to more battle inclined students. Rumor has it in his youth he fought for the attention and love of the Mournful Lady, but she choose another over him. When her lover died, he hoped to blaze the old flame, but she kept to ghost of her companion instead of seeking consolation in his arms. This made him only loathe necromancers and undead more, transferring his unresolved feeling into external objects, which were easier to hate.

Sister Annabelle of Holy Cross - a relatively young nun of Three Sisters who teaches the magic of water and healing and is a caretaker of House of Holy Water. She is kind of timid and speaks with a quiet voice shaking with emotion. While she is a deeply empathetic and moral figure, she is a little bit too focused on personal aspects of spirituality and a little bit not believing in herself to be a good teacher. she is much more interested in theology and academic medicine than in teaching, to be honest, which she believes she has no true talent for. Still, she is always ready to offer an ear and arm to the students in need of someone to listen to their woes and problems, no matter which house they hail from. Truth is, Annabelle would be much, much better teacher is she would just believe in herself and found her inner resolve.

Madame Lucilla Hex - an elderly lady and the current headmistress of the Academy. In her youth, she was a soldier and fire wizard, then she became a general during the war with the Empire, in order to then turn into a headmistress of the Continent's foremost mystical academy. Lucilla is cold, expects a lot from her students and likes strict regimen. As such, it is better that she maintain the finances of the school, keeps in touch with Coalition's leaders, read voraciously, maintains a vast network of spies all around the world and yet finds some free time to work on state-of-the-art magical research. Her acting headmaster is taking care of students and the way they are fostered and educated, and she herself has other, much more ambitious projects.

It's also true that even though she has a brilliant career she never learned how to relax and understand the goings in a stress-free relationships. She would not admit to that in front of a mirror, but she is kind of scared of people that aren't her subordinates

or enemies on the battlefield, and in truth she is delighted and relieved that she has someone else to get care of all the "public face of the Academy" stuff.

Mister Julius Milano - known to his students mostly as Mister Julius, is an acting headmaster of the Academy, whose duties are related to the student body directly. When a student, he was enlisted in the House of Wind Rose. He is nice, kind-hearted, believes in his students and tries his best to be a good influence for them and treat them justly and with dignity. People are of the view that he would not be too good of a headmaster, but being second in charge suits him and his personality quite well.

Julius was born over 40 years ago to the Crown Family of The Rose Empire and is in fact a uncle of the current Empress. He could never claim the rule in the country, but he got a nice, proper, classical education, which included such areas as languages, politics, diplomacy and savoir vivre - knowledge and skills he still uses to this day in his job. He also has proper connections and some ability to influence his niece, which is an added bonus he uses for the betterment of the Dragon Academy as a whole.

His hobbies include gardening, classical music and baking sweets.

Eloise Vodereil - the academy young psychologist and teacher of communication and empathy spells. Eloise truly believes in non-violent solutions and that everything can be solved with the zero amount of spilled blood. She had taken the job in order to try and influence new generations of mages into non-combat solutions, proper communication and showing empathy to other people, which she hopes will change the surface of the world much more than another fireball or machine of destruction.

Besides teaching her kind of magic and being a psychologist, Eloise also teaches social sciences and is a matron of debates club as the Dragon Academy. Knitting is how she spends her free time and during the colder months of the year she is seen all the time in her own hand-made jumpers.

Circle - a living, two-dimensional, floating circle of magical energy and constantly changing strokes of chalk. Circle was created as a experiment in living magic performed by Madame Lucilla Hex and it turned out to be one of her best creations. So good, actually, that the headmistress, after realizing potency and complexity of a being she created, offered it a job at her own Academy. Circle graciously accepted, and now it is a teacher of Protection and Warding spells - a task important in every school for magical warriors.

Circle's personal interest encompass higher mathematics, such as geometry (especially fractals) and the number theory, philosophy and theology. It also likes, quite surprisingly, a good game, whether board one, card or just putting together some playful words. It is agender and accepts all pronouns when used by others, but speaks of itself only as "it".

(Yes, it speaks of itself in the third person, like "This person is happy. It had been working hard and now it's achieved success...")

Hamnir Blackhammer - a redhaired dwarf that is the main smith at the Steam and Cogwheel Dragon Academy. first he joined the school as a means to safely and fastly leave debts his clan had made, but now he is wholeheartedly supporting the mission of the school. He is kinda grumpy, likes to be alone and speaks little, but has the heart in the right place.

Both students of the Houses of Enchanted Blaze and Knowledge Saved in Cogs quite frequently end up as his apprentices - the first ones creating magical items, and the second group learning how to build and maintain non-magical tech. Hamnir is equally skilled in both lines of work and is actually pretty happy and proud of his students progresses.

Even though stereotypically dwarves and elves do not like each other, Hamnir possesses deep respect for ages-long wisdom of Elenarila and the passion she puts in her own branch of magic. He seems in her something truthfully similar to his own passion, when the new item leaves his smithy. They aren't really "friends" - Hamnir can be pretty grumpy and quiet at most times - but still, they get along quite well.

3 Religions

The world of The Steam and Cogwheel Dragon Academy has many religions. Some of them are:

Three Sisters - ancient healers and crones who walked the world, from village to village, and miraculously cured people of all ailments. It is said that when they have finally died, after long years of services to humanity, Celestial Inhabitants were moved by their sacrifice and good deeds, and made them into Three Goddesses who now watch over the ill and their doctors. The Church of the Three officially supports the House of Holy Water, and the graduates of the House have always a ready place amid the clergy, if only they wish for it.

Fiery Swordman - a new religion in the last 100 years. The Fiery Swordman was a wizard-warrior who studies the arts of holy flames and their effect on the undead. By burning dead bodies, everywhere where he went, and teaching if the benefits of such actions, the Fiery Swordman wanted to limit the amount of undead in the world. As there are strong cultural beliefs that body souls stay whole after the death (which necromancers technically comply with, unless they are necro-surgeons), the religion of Fiery Swordman is pretty controversial even nowadays. Most of overly zealous members of House of Enchanted Blaze support this religion, believing means are a way to an end.

While the Fiery Swordman himself hadn't ascended to the position of a god (unlike Three Sisters), he established during his lifetime a quasi-religious order that operates till this day. The organization is especially popular in the country of Motstand.

The Necro King - an ancient being said to be God whom other Gods cast out of the Heavens. Exiled from his native land, he took a refuge in the Far North, where he created both undead and diseases previously unknown on the Material Plane. Since he knows he cannot return to Heavens, his aim is to make all the inhabitants of the Prime Material suffer as much, as he does by being exiled, if not more. This desire for revenge and punishment made him quite crazy, but he cares not. He has all the eternity to finally fulfill his goal.

There are gossips of The Necro King cult among the members of House Grave-stone, but even the most wicked of them would not choose someone, who promises eternal damnation in exchange for magical power... right?

The Church of Eternal Gemstones Encased in Perpetua Automata - relatively new religious order. The Church seals souls of living beings in precious gemstones, and then puts them inside of automatons, which are controlled by the stones. As such, the Church offers effective immortality without turning to the spells given to the humankind by The necro king.

The process is pretty expensive - most of that comes from the precious gemstone used in the ritual - but there is also talk of the Church hierarchy being greedy and money-hungry. According to rumors, the lesser clergymen wanted to research a version of the ritual that would be much more cheap and efficient, just to be dealt harshly with. It's hard to tell whether such rumors are true or not, but it's true that thanks to their activities, the Church of Eternal Gemstones got to be one of the richest organi-

zations on the continent. For now, they are quite content with their status quo.

The Movement of 1001 Gods and Godlings - a dominant metareligion on the continent. It isn't as much religion as awareness of a simple fact - the Gods and Godlings are numerous and varied. The Movement maintains that all of them should get their due worship, according to their position, movements of the planets, calendar and the events occurring in a local society.

The Movement teaches some obvious truths, like that the souls can exist only as long as there are their mortal remains put into sacred earth, that the exception to that is a dead body destroyed as a result of following orders of a necromancer (since neither the dead person neither their mourners are guilty in such a case), and that if a body of a dead person would burn to ashes, so would the soul of the deceased the very same instant. Not all of the claims are directly supported by modern-day occultism studies, but even the weaker proved ones are believed by magical experts to be generally true and able to be shown as facts in the coming centuries of magical and technological development. Which, of course, puts the Fiery Swordsman in a somehow... *interesting* position...

Cults of the Dragonkin - a religion dominant in the Empire of Dragon Blood, considered by the rest of continent to be blasphemous, as it provides creatures of flesh and blood with worship meant only to be the deed of truly Immortals (which dragons are obviously not, as they can become dead, and even undead). The Cults each worships a single dragon and their bloodline. In exchange, the Dragon mixes with humans and provides them with their immense magical power. This power is the reason why Empire of Dragon Blood is so expansive and constantly looking for colonising new lands.

Whisperer in Dreams - not so much a religious cult as rather a new magical phenomenon. Some people have been receiving vivid visions in dreams, in which a long-forgotten God of Frozen Islands calls upon them and wants them to come to him. The entity, even though they have never spoken their name aloud, has been called Whisperer in Dreams. The visions started a few months ago and slowly, but gradually increased in both frequency and power they push at the dreamers. If this trend will continue, something will need to have been done about this situation. Or, maybe, the Whisperer will go bad to the sleep through which it tries to influence the populace?

4 Countries and Regions

Empire of Dragon Blood - place where worship of god got exchanged to worship of dragons. The Emperor rules the EMpire in name, but in truth it's the Dragonic Council which is the governing body - the Emperor is just a puppet. Because of the Dragonic appetite for new lands, slaves and magic, it was fighting many wars in the history of the continent. In order to protect themselves, the loose Coalition of Progress decided to develop their magical and technological knowledge further than their shared enemy. This resulted in Age of Reason in every continental country - with the exception of Empire of Dragon Blood, which is still technologically on the level of development of Middle Ages, and which magical talents come from droplets of dragon blood in the bloodstream of Warlocks, instead of studied theories of Coalition's Wizards.

Countries of the **Coalition of Progress** are;

The Rose Empire - the country famous for magical roses that grow in its imperial gardens, and the second biggest country on the continent after Empire of Dragon Blood. The Roses of the Empire have many magical properties, depending on their colors - white are used for healing, red as aphrodisiacs and for sexual magic, blue as relaxants and recreational drugs, yellow can force truth out of a person, and black are used when somebody needs to get killed, to name just a few. The Roses grow in imperial gardens and are exclusive property of the Empress. While it's a serious crime to steal the Roses from her, the black market for such good is flourishing.

The current Empress - the Rose Empire is a matriarchy - is Empress Rosalinda the 9th. This subtle young woman, with long golden hair and eyes as deep, blue ocean, while invests in army, magic and technology just like her advisors deem necessary, is a kind of naive and hopeful person, which believes that due to diplomacy, she will be able to prevent the next conflict with Empire of Dragon Blood. As such, she opens new embassies in the neighbourly EMpire and hopes for the best. So far the Dragons did not shatter her hopes, most likely waiting for the right time to attack.

The country of **Motstand** lies in the far north, in the mountains eternally covered by snow and ice. The country was established in the shadow of Necro King, but when has almost no functioning agricultural land, is very rich in metals, including iron, gold and adamantium. The country is also worldwide famous because of its smiths.

Because the country of Motstand has to deal with the Necro King and his creations directly, their populace has somehow different views on practical theology. The population is adherents to the teachings of Fiery Swordman, and burns their dead in an effort to leave the Necro King without supplies. This causes theological conflicts and political debates between Motstand and other countries of the Coalition.

Il Regno del Belpaese or simply **Belpaese** is a former group of separated city-states joined into one country by Queen Anna Maria di Girasole. Yet, the unification is relatively new chapter in the history of the country. As such, every city-state has their own dialect, not always easily understandable by people from other parts of the country, and fires of rebellion still burn in hearts of the citizens.

Because Belpaese is located far on the south and west of the continent, it has

no direct contact with Dragon Blood Empire. As such, it's politicians could and can dabble in politics for politics sake, being freed from direct danger. As such, modern day Regno is a vipers' nest, full of dangers of political nature. The aristocrasts attend their balls and dances, whisper sweet words, and utmost fail is never out of questions. Out of all the courts of the Coalition, the Belpaese is possibly the most dangerous and unpredictable for political players. But no matter how dangerous is the political life of the country, nobody can refuse them the sense of style and glamour.

Belpaese is also known as the undisputed capital of technomagic and steam engines. It is here where the concept was born and it is here where the magical engineers stem from. The Regno intends to keep its supremacy in the area in the incoming years.

Kraina Nieszczęściem Przeklęta, known simply as **Kraina** or by its translation of **Realm** in the Common language of Roses, stretches between the Rose Empire and the country of Motstand, is a land of hardworking people, who nonetheless can't even achieve happiness or success. As the story goes, in ancient Kraina, there was a powerful mage-king. The king wanted to throw a challenge against gods and eventually killed the god of the land, trying to steal his domain and powers. However, the act of killing a God created a perpetual spiritual waste over the whole country. When the mage-king realized, what he had done, it was already too late to revert the thing. In his dying breath, the ruler casted a powerful spell that changed the rules of magic itself, in order for such a blasphemy to never again happen in this world. Thus, the Realm was the first and only country to kill its God.

It's been over a thousand years since, yet the citizens of Realm always have it the worst. When famine strikes, they have the least to eat. When floodings happen, the most water gathers in Realm. When war erupts, the most people die here and the biggest damages happen here. And not once in 1 000 years, the citizens could rest from hard work, which nonetheless brought them nothing.

The only ray of hope is the fact that it's the land which is cursed, not its people. As such, Realmers are the biggest group of expatriots, living extensively in other countries, when they can achieve fame, riches and happiness denied to them in their native land.

The only group of truly hopeful people inside of Kraina are Winged Hussars, elite group of knights, whom believe in betterment of their people and ability to cast aside the curse through hard work and building up community. Nobody in the Realm truly believes them, yet the sight of winged horsemen in full armor brings pride if not hope, in the hearts of the general populace.

The Sunken Atoranto, known also as **The Sunken Wastes and Pillars of Stone**, was once upon a time a land of great forest growing in the fertile plateau. The elves created a magical barrier called Mythal. Yet, one king of the Elves got seduced by gold of the Empire of the Dragon Blood and its promise of power and betrayed its people. When the Council of Mages realized, the only things they could do was to bury their beautiful forest in the sea, in order to protect their powerful magic from falling into wrong hands. As such, Atoranto has sunk in the waves, forever inaccessible to Dragonic Lords.

However, it was not the end of the country. Elves were always very in touch with their land and its features shaped their magic. When Atoranto sunked, the elves evolved, changing from forest elves to sea elves. Now, breathing the pure sea water, they recreated their civilization under the waves, building beautiful cities and palaces that the inhabitants of the surface world can only look at when swimming in boats under the endless expanse of their lands. The land known by sea elves as fertile, beautiful and inhabitable for others is known for its vast area, being inaccessible and full of stone pillars, between of which only the most skillful captains can maneuver with safety. These days, sea elves do not get many visitors, but they aren't bothered by it. Their land, magic and way of life survived, and this is the only thing that matters to them.

The Sunken Atoranto is governed by council of 7 Sages, who have the greatest magical power and are the wisest in all the land. The system got changed after the Betrayal of a King, and since then sea elves had no need of anything better.

Borowia and the Black Mountain - is a relatively small country laying on the west of Kraina. In ancient times, Angels from Heavens have closed the gates to 7 Hells and entrusted the gilded key to the gates to the Kings of Borowia. However, the kings weren't careful enough, the key got stolen by agents of evil and the Gates of Black Mountain got opened again. As such, many monstrosities erupted - werewolves, ghosts, vampires, ghouls, zombies, skeletons, demons, devils, strigas and many more. As such, Borowia became a land of danger, terror and sadness. The fact that many heroic people from many corners of known world came to Borowia and the Black Mountain since that fateful day is a little compensation, cause the monsters are never ending.

The general population of Borowia turned to hedge witches and witch doctors in order to gain at least some illusion of safety. As such, many superstitions, especially regarding good luck and monsters warding, as extremely popular among Borowians.

Holy Republic of Angels is a place where Angels, the messengers of 1001 Gods and Godlings, have made their presence known for the first time. Some of them even mingled with the local population, creating aasimars, the descendants of angels and humans. Because of that the Holy Republic believes itself to be better managed, ruled and on higher intellectual and political level than other countries of the continent.

Truth be told, aasimars have angelic blood, but nowadays are very far removed from their Angelic ancestors, with whom links is shown only in their enormous height, blonde hair and deep blue, often way too cold, calculating eyes. As dangerous political ideologies, crowds blinded by hate and charismatic, yet deadly empty political leaders, and plans of the Great Redeeming invasion take hold of the Republicans, the rest of the world might find themselves in a very dangerous situation. Yet, it is not too late now for some action, be it education, killing the Fuhler or maybe making an preemptive strike. the fate of Holy Republic and the whole worlds isn't decided yet, and hope still grows in hearts of the ones who wish for peace and spirit of camaraderie.

12 Colonies of the New World - is a comparatively new political entity. founded in the virgin fresh lands beyond the Great ocean, which became accessible only by the technomagic of Age of Reason, the country is growing on the international stage,

offering new chance for everybody, far from the Empire of Dragon blood and its constant dangers. Current President, Mr. John Smith, is leading an expansion campaign deeper into the newly discovered territory, and established a program for skilled immigrants from the Old Continent. Yet, the inhabitants of the Coalition believe that leaving their motherlands and living easily in a new country, without the rich history of Old Continent Countries is an act of treason, that, if made massively, could weaken the coalition to strikes of the Empire. As result of such patriotic tendencies, 12 Colonies do not attract as many gifted citizens as they are hoping for.

Frozen Islands - a medium size archipelago far north, above the Empire of Dragon Blood and Motstand. The archipelago is very mysterious, dotted with ancient ruins of unknown origin. The place is cold, desolate and located far away from the civilisations of the continent. Whats more, the magic is here accidental, erroneous and often dangerous. As such, so far there has been little interest in researching properly what lies up north. However, as the continent enters an Age of Progress, new technological means may appear where there was no chance with using classical magic.

Quite recently, sensitive people across the Continent have experienced vivid dreamy visions of the Frozen Islands during their golden age - an inhumane cities crowded with inhumane inhabitants. The visions are pretty scary, and feature predominantly a sleeping God in a deep cave in an anormous mountain in the middle of the archipelago. Still, some people seem to be addicted to the rush of adrenaline the terrific visions pump through them.

The Dragon Academy has received a proposal of researching the topic further, but so far is has not been accepted.

5 Other Schools of Magic

Many School of Magic exist on the continent. The most prominent are taught by the Steam and Cogwheel Dragon Academy, but there is more to magic than the 5 Houses it hosts. Below are some examples:

The School of Elven Druids, Ancient - a half-forgotten magical school focusing on the magic of Plants and Animals. Ancient elves - also called forest elves - lived in the grandest, greatest and most magical forest of all and this was shown in the kind of magic they performed. Even though the forest elves are no more, some people practice the magic they left behind.

The School of Elven Druids, Modern - the new school of druidic magic that has been formed in the place of the old one. It focuses on magic of Water and Weather, being better suited to the kind of place Sunken Atoranto is today. Especially popular among sailors, their practitioners often visit every port in the world more than once on occasion, and as such are well versed in languages and customs of far-away places.

The Twisted Art of Forcing Limitations - the dual art of controlling and limiting both mind and body. Instead of the magic of House of Gravestone, which focuses on both negative magic of necromancy and positive magic of the element of earth, this school has no good side, and as such was wholly banned among the members of the Coalition. However, the Dragonic Empire has no such inhibitions and practitioners quite often find themselves in the dragon armies, opposing the countries of the Age of Progress.

Most Proper and Satisfying Recipes for a Healthy and Happy Life - this "school" is just using the magic of Food in order to make both oneself and people in their surrounding happy, healthy, friendly... and maybe gain an extra silver piece. This school of magic is practiced by cooks, chiefs and housewives. Many manuals exist and it is possibly the simplest and most widespread kind of magic in the whole world. Still, studying Food magic, while has some benefits, is believed to be even less serious than the magic of House of Wind Rose.

While not officially taught at the Dragon Academy, a bunch of students - most of them ladies - has established a semi-official club for learning and casting these spells. What's interesting is the fact that within walls of that club, House rivalries seem to fade away, quelled by nice food and a few uplifting drinks. Their teacher-patron is the Laid-back Satyr (mostly because of the spell that allows him to have as much red wine as he wants).

Witchery and Warlockery of the Big Blue Moon - is not as much of a school of magic as rather a whole new paradigm of casting spells. The power and sanity of the Witches and Warlocks wanes and increases together with the phases of the Moon on the night sky. When the Moon is full, the magic is the most potent, but also their sanity shatters. When there is no Moon, the casters find themselves powerless, but also extremely calm and in mental control. Most of the times, both phenomena are somewhere in between.

Witches and Warlocks cast usually the spells of nature, 4 basic elements and healing ones. However, a few turned their magic into truly wicked, dark means -

stories of such casters are whispered thorough the land with true dread and terror.

The Voices of Peace - in part a school of magic, in part an organization of similarly-minded people, Voices teach and research magic of communication and empathy in hopes of preventing future wars. They support their magical powers with vast education - in psychology and social sciences, humanities, history, literature, philosophy and ethics, foreign languages and inter-cultural theory, diplomacy and geography, just to name a few fields that are of interest to the Voices of Peace. Mages of this school are hoping to save the world some day - and who knows, maybe they will even be able to succeed?

Still Aether - a more radical offshoot of the Voices of Peace. Where Voices believe that peace is possible through meeting in the middle of all nations, Still Aether views things vastly differently - the problems is not the wars, but the magic itself. The wizards of Coalition and Dragonic Empire, the Steam and Cogwheel Dragon Academy, the Imperial Dragons - all of this enables and empowers wars, in a vicious, never-ending cycle. But some day, the Still Aether organization will rid the world of it's overflowing mana, of grimoires, wizards, magical academies and magical weapons - and on this beautiful, joyous day all the wars will turn invalid, whether the people will learn to respect each other or now. According to the Still Aether, that's the only sure way to guarantee the everlasting peace. And the members will stop at nothing in order to bring that reality to fulfillment.